

Module 3

Arrays and Linear Search

Last time:

We had a very short overview of the Collections Framework in Java.

Conceptually, collections are objects that group other objects.

In Java, collections are a set of interfaces and classes that are available for you to use in the `java.util` package.

There are three major interfaces: List, Set and Map.

These interfaces are implemented as ArrayList, LinkedList, HashSet, TreeSet, HashMap, and TreeMap.

We also saw that there are major operations we can perform on them:

- Addition (Insertion)
- Removal (Deletion)
- Sorting
- Searching
- Iteration (Traversal)
- Copying (Cloning)

Now we will kick off our explorations of data structures, starting with Arrays.

Problem at hand

I would like to have my class roster for this course for which I plan to develop a very simple application.

My first question would be “what kind of data should I use?”

How about student id numbers? (No duplicates)

And the next question is “what kind of operations do I need?”

Conceptual View of Arrays

Given the following array with student ids!

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
84	61	15	73	26	38	11	49	53	

Addition (Insertion)

Add a new id, 91, to the end!

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
84	61	15	73	26	38	11	49	53	91

Add a new id, 23, at the beginning of the initial array

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
23	84	61	15	73	26	38	11	49	53

Searching

To search for 84, how many items should we go through? _____

How about searching for 10? How many items should we go through? _____

This is linear search. It is also called sequential search and the simplest search algorithm but its worst-case cost is proportional to the number of elements.

Removal (Deletion)

After removal of 73 (Cannot have a hole!)

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
84	61	15		26	38	11	49	53	91

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	
84	61	15	26	38	11	49	53	91	

Arrays in Memory

Typically, array elements are stored in adjacent memory cells. And index is used to calculate an offset to find the desired element.

Primitive int in Java is 4 bytes (32 bits).

Address	200	204	208	212	216
Content					

If we want the third data value, we take the address of the start of the array and the offset * the size of an array element to find the element we want.

Location of data[2] is $200 + 2 * 4 = 208$

Arrays in Java

Arrays in Java can hold primitives and references. Good for storing and accessing a sequence of data.

An array in Java, in terms of manipulating its data, has *one method*, *clone()*, and *one **immutable field***, *length*.

To ease some frustrations you might have, Java has the `java.util.Arrays` class. The `java.util.Arrays` class has some static methods that are useful working with arrays.

Examples of using static methods in Arrays class

```
int[] a = { 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 };
int[] b = { 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 };

if (Arrays._____(a, b)) {
    System.out.println("Arrays with same contents");
}
```

How about this? Which will be printed?

```
if (a == b) {
    System.out.println("a == b is true");
} else {
    System.out.println("a == b is false");
}
```

Printing values of an array?

```
int[] c = { 3, 4, 2, 5, 1 };
System.out.println(c);
System.out.println(_____);
```

How about sorting?

```
Arrays._____(c);
```

How about copying?

```
int[] d = Arrays.copyOf(c, c.length);
```

The second parameter specifies the length of the new array. It could be less, equal or bigger than the original length.

However, there is a better or flexible way to copy data between arrays which is done by using `System.arraycopy()` method.

It requires five arguments. Here is its signature.

```
public static void arraycopy(Object source, int srcIndex, Object
destination, int destIndex, int length)
```

What does this code print?

```
int[] e = { 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 };
int[] f = new int[e.length];
System.arraycopy(e, 0, f, 0, 3);
System.out.println(Arrays.toString(f));
```

The other choice for copying is using cloning.

```
int[] g = { 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 };
int[] h = g.clone();
```

In cloning process, it creates a new array of the same size and type and copies (*shallow copy!*) the elements from the original array into the new array.

Insertion and Deletion

Once again, arrays in Java have an **immutable field**, `length`. It is useful for you to find the length of an array.

```
int arrayLength = h.length;
```

However, once an array is created, its length is fixed and cannot be changed.

Now, how can we resize the array?

It is done by creating a new array with a different length and copying all or some of the values from the old array to the new array.

For example, the following code is to delete an element from an array of char data set.

```
// removes item at specified position (index)
// and returns a new array
// if not within bounds, return the same array
public static char[] delete(char[] data, int pos)    {
    if (pos >= 0 && pos < data.length) {
        char[] tmp = new char[_____];
        System.arraycopy(data, 0, tmp, 0, _____);
        System.arraycopy(data, _____, tmp, pos, _____);
        return tmp;
    }
    return data;
}
```

Efficiency of Arrays (Worst-case in Big O notation)

Insertion at back: _____

Insertion at front: _____

Insertion in middle: _____

Searching (using linear search): _____

Deletion: _____

Access to an element with its index: _____

Summary and Review

Arrays might be a good choice if:

- The amount of data is reasonably small
- The amount of data is predictable in advance

Can you see why now?

Remember! Arrays have a FIELD, length, and it is IMMUTABLE.

In Module 4, we will look at ArrayList to find out how it handles the issue of the fixed length of arrays and its capabilities.